

CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

HOW A GLOBAL TECHNOLOGY COMPANY REDUCED CAC BY 25% THROUGH FUNNEL OPTIMISATION

USING CHANNEL MIX, BUYER-JOURNEY ANALYSIS, LANDING-PAGE IMPROVEMENT AND TESTING TO IMPROVE ACQUISITION EFFICIENCY

Organisation	Global technology company with a cybersecurity education and certification portfolio
Period	May 2021 - September 2023
Role / scope	Senior Manager - Performance Marketing Acquisition efficiency and conversion optimisation
Audience	CMOs, marketing leaders, CEOs and hiring managers

EXECUTIVE OUTCOME

The work reduced customer acquisition cost by 25%, from \$340 to \$255. The intervention connected channel mix, audience targeting, buyer-journey analysis, landing-page optimisation and A/B testing. The customer-success story is not simply that a cost line fell; it is that the team created a repeatable method for finding and removing funnel friction. The metric is documented, while scope, period and customer definition should still be confirmed.

METRIC REGISTER AND PUBLICATION STATUS

Each metric is either documented in the supplied profile/project material or marked as an illustrative validation item. Validation items are prompts for recovering the original baseline, denominator, source and attribution; they are not public claims.

Metric	Value	Definition	Status / publication note
CAC reduction	25%	Decrease in acquisition cost from the documented baseline to the documented after value.	Documented outcome; confirm customer and cost definition.
CAC baseline	\$340	Starting customer acquisition cost.	Documented outcome; confirm currency, period and denominator.
CAC after	\$255	Post-optimisation customer acquisition cost.	Documented outcome; confirm currency, period and denominator.
Conversion uplift	Validation required	Change in conversion rate at the relevant funnel step.	Illustrative validation item - not a claim.

BUSINESS CONTEXT AND CUSTOMER CHALLENGE

Customer acquisition cost is shaped by audience quality, offer fit, creative, landing-page clarity, form friction, follow-up speed and sales progression. In a complex education portfolio, the middle of the funnel is especially important.

The challenge was to reduce CAC without relying on a blunt budget cut. A lower spend figure can look efficient while shrinking growth, and a cheaper lead can create more work for sales if quality deteriorates.

STRATEGIC DIAGNOSIS

Optimisation opportunities were distributed across the funnel. Some channels may have reached the wrong audiences, some messages may have attracted curiosity and some landing pages may not have answered buyer questions.

The approach combined quantitative evidence with buyer-journey reasoning. Data showed where drop-off occurred, while context helped explain whether the remedy belonged in targeting, messaging, experience or follow-up.

CAMPAIGN SUCCESS MATRIX

The matrix makes the operating logic visible: business need, strategic move, execution system and success signal. It is deliberately designed for executive readers who want to understand how the work created a repeatable capability, not only a headline result.

Business need	Strategic move	Execution system	Success signal
Efficiency	reduce cost without reducing quality	Funnel analysis and channel-mix review	CAC from \$340 to \$255
Audience fit	reach people more likely to progress	Segmentation, targeting and intent signals	More qualified response
Message fit	align promise with buyer need	Offer, creative and A/B testing	Improved engagement quality
Durability	make improvement repeatable	Experiment backlog and measurement definitions	25% documented reduction

APPROACH AND EXECUTION

1. 1. MAP THE ACQUISITION JOURNEY

The first move was reduce cost without reducing quality. The team mapped exposure, landing experience, information needs, form or checkout, follow-up and customer event. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a

complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. The team mapped exposure, landing experience, information needs, form or checkout, follow-up and customer event. The work was reviewed through the lens of efficiency, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. CAC from \$340 to \$255 The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

2. 2. EVALUATE AUDIENCE QUALITY

The first move was reach people more likely to progress. Channel performance was read alongside downstream behaviour instead of celebrating low-cost leads alone. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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3. 3. OPTIMISE LANDING EXPERIENCES

The first move was align promise with buyer need. Testing addressed message match, proof, call to action, form structure and the clarity of the next step. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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4. 4. CONNECT RESULT TO CAC

The first move was make improvement repeatable. The method gave the team a way to return to the data, identify the next constraint and prioritise the next intervention. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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MEASUREMENT, ATTRIBUTION AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

CAC should be total acquisition cost divided by the number of new customers acquired in the same period. The cost basis must be explicit. The documented movement from \$340 to \$255 is strong proof, but the final public version should confirm currency, customer event and scope.

A senior reader should be able to tell which evidence proves execution, which evidence proves engagement and which evidence proves commercial impact. The case therefore keeps metric definitions close to the story. Where the supplied material documents a practice-level or portfolio-level result, the narrative says so. Where a project-specific number is unavailable, the document names the recovery task instead of manufacturing precision.

BUSINESS IMPACT AND CUSTOMER-SUCCESS INTERPRETATION

The business gained more efficient customer acquisition without making cost reduction the only objective. The method connected performance marketing with experience design and buyer understanding.

For a CMO or hiring manager, the case demonstrates commercially mature performance marketing: attention to campaign detail combined with a view of customer economics, conversion friction, quality and repeatable learning.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES TO AN EXECUTIVE READER

- CAC reduction should be evaluated alongside customer quality and growth volume.
- The cheapest lead is not necessarily the cheapest customer.
- Testing is most valuable when it answers a buyer-behaviour question.
- Metric definitions should be visible in the case study.

End of case study